

SECTION 11

MMIWG2S+

The 2019 National Inquiry concluded that the missing and murdered Indigenous women and girls crisis amounts to genocide. The Inquiry produced 231 Calls for Justice. By the fifth anniversary, two had been completed. As this report is being written in April 2026, MMIWG2S+ program funding is sunsetting at the federal level, threatening the few mechanisms that exist to protect Indigenous women, girls, and Two-Spirit people — the same population whose disability profiles, where they survive, this report has been documenting throughout.

Indigenous women are 12 times more likely to be murdered or to go missing than non-Indigenous women in Canada. They are 16 percent of all female homicide victims and 11 percent of missing women, while comprising only 4.3 percent of the Canadian population. The 2019 National Inquiry into Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Girls concluded, in its Final Report, that this constitutes a genocide. As of April 2026, of 231 Calls for Justice the Inquiry produced, two have been completed.”

This section documents the MMIWG2S+ crisis as it intersects with the disability dimension this report has been tracing. The section builds on Sections 9 and 10: the same provincial child welfare apprehension pattern that produces the 17-to-1 disparity in Section 9 and the 10.2-to-1 incarceration disparity in Section 10 produces the 12-to-1 disparity in murder and disappearance documented here. The pipeline does not stop at the prison. For Indigenous women specifically, particularly those whose vulnerabilities include disability, the pipeline ends in violent death or disappearance at a rate the National Inquiry characterized as genocidal.

Five findings structure the section. First, that the 2019 National Inquiry's legal characterization of MMIWG2S+ as genocide is the operative finding under which Canadian federal and provincial governments are now obligated to act. Second, that the 231 Calls for Justice the Inquiry produced have been substantively unimplemented, with only two completed as of June 2024 according to the Assembly of First Nations' own progress reporting. Third, that as of April 2026 — the month this report is being published — federal funding for MMIWG2S+ programs is being allowed to sunset, with the National Family and Survivors Circle and Giganawenimaanaanig both publicly reporting unrenewed core funding. Fourth, that disability is documented in the MMIWG2S+ literature as a specific compounding vulnerability factor, intersecting with poverty, housing insecurity, and the institutional histories this report has documented across previous sections. Fifth, that Alberta's administrative apparatus for AISH

withdrawal, child apprehension, and incarceration documented in Sections 9 and 10 produces the precise destabilization conditions the National Inquiry identified as upstream causes of MMIWG2S+ vulnerability.

Part 1: The National Inquiry and the genocide finding

The Inquiry

The National Inquiry into Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Girls was established by the Government of Canada in September 2016, building on Truth and Reconciliation Commission Call to Action 41.2, which directed the federal government to create an independent inquiry into the disproportionate violence experienced by Indigenous women and girls. The Inquiry was led by four commissioners. Over the next two and a half years, the Inquiry heard testimony from more than 2,380 family members of murdered and missing Indigenous women and girls, survivors of violence, expert witnesses, and Knowledge Keepers.

On June 3, 2019, the Inquiry released its Final Report, titled *Reclaiming Power and Place: The Final Report of the National Inquiry into Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Girls*. The Final Report was delivered to Prime Minister Justin Trudeau in a ceremony at the Canadian Museum of History in Gatineau, Quebec. The two-volume report was the culmination of the most comprehensive primary-source documentation ever assembled in Canada on violence against Indigenous women, girls, and 2SLGBTQQIA+ people.

The genocide finding

The Inquiry's Final Report concluded that the documented pattern of disappearance and murder of Indigenous women, girls, and 2SLGBTQQIA+ people in Canada constitutes a genocide. The legal and conceptual basis for this finding is set out in detail in a supplementary legal analysis accompanying the report, drawing on the United Nations Convention on the Prevention and Punishment of the Crime of Genocide (1948) and on the cumulative effect of Canadian colonial law and practice across the centuries the Inquiry documented.

The Final Report stated: "The steps to end and redress this genocide must be no less monumental than the combination of systems and actions that have worked to maintain colonial violence for generations." The genocide finding is the operative legal and political characterization that frames the 231 Calls for Justice. It is not advocacy framing. It is the conclusion of a federally-commissioned independent inquiry led by four Commissioners, drawing on more than 2,380 sources of testimony.

The scale of the disparity

The Inquiry documented, and subsequent statistical reporting has confirmed, the scale of the disparity:

- Indigenous women are 12 times more likely to go missing or be murdered than non-Indigenous women in Canada.
- Indigenous women comprise 16 percent of all female homicide victims in Canada, while comprising only 4.3 percent of the Canadian population — an overrepresentation ratio of approximately 3.7-to-1.
- Indigenous women comprise 11 percent of missing women in Canada — an overrepresentation ratio of approximately 2.6-to-1.
- 56 percent of Indigenous women have suffered physical assault. 46 percent have experienced sexual assault. By comparison, approximately one-third of non-Indigenous women have suffered these assaults in their lifetimes.
- 13 percent of Indigenous people experience violence from a current or ex-partner — a rate twice that of non-Indigenous people (5.7 percent).

The cumulative effect is genocide. — National Inquiry into Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Girls, Reclaiming Power and Place: Final Report (2019)”

Part 2: The 231 Calls for Justice and the implementation failure

The structure of the Calls

The Inquiry’s Final Report contains 231 individual Calls for Justice, organized into 18 main areas of reform. The Calls are directed at governments at all levels, police, health providers, the justice system, the media, social service providers, industries, and all Canadians. Distinctive Calls for Justice are issued specifically for Inuit, Métis, and 2SLGBTQQIA people, recognizing the differentiated needs and harms within the broader population.

The Calls cover the full range of structural conditions the Inquiry identified as producing MMIWG2S+ vulnerability:

- Calls for Justice 1.1 through 1.11 address the foundational legal, governance, and accountability framework, including the development of a National Action Plan, full compliance with UNDRIP and the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child, elimination of social, economic, cultural, and political marginalization, representation in governance, and creation of an independent national Indigenous oversight body.
- Subsequent Calls address health and wellness, human security including housing and food security, justice and policing, child welfare, education, media representation, and the specific Calls for Inuit, Métis, and 2SLGBTQQIA persons.
- Many of the Calls correspond directly to the structural failures documented elsewhere in this report: housing inadequacy (Section 4), water and environmental contamination (Sections 5 and

6), healthcare system failure and anti-Indigenous racism in healthcare (Section 7), Jordan's Principle (Section 8), child welfare (Section 9), and the justice system (Section 10). The MMIWG2S+ Calls for Justice are, in operational terms, a remedial framework that addresses the same upstream causes this report has documented across all preceding sections.

The implementation failure

In June 2023, four years after the Final Report's release, CBC published a comprehensive analysis of the implementation status of all 231 Calls for Justice across federal, provincial, and territorial jurisdictions. The analysis found that of the 231 Calls, only two had been completed. More than half had not even been started — categorized by CBC as Calls for which promises may have been made or money may have been committed, but no change has been effected and no money has been spent.

In June 2024, the Assembly of First Nations released its Progress on Breathing Life into the Calls for Justice: A CFJ Progress Report — the first AFN-led monitoring report on implementation. National Chief Cindy Woodhouse-Nepinak's public assessment, marking the fifth anniversary of the Final Report on June 3, 2024: only two of the 231 recommendations have been met. Five years of federal, provincial, and territorial action has produced substantive completion of less than one percent of the Inquiry's recommendations.

There is a long, winding road ahead to address and prevent all forms of gender-based violence. — National Chief Cindy Woodhouse-Nepinak, Assembly of First Nations, June 2024, on the fifth anniversary of the MMIWG Final Report"

The specific failures the AFN documents

The AFN's 2024 Progress Report documents specific structural failures across the implementation framework. Examples include:

- Call for Justice 1.7 — the creation of a national Indigenous and human rights ombudsperson and tribunal — has been the subject of a Ministerial Special Representative process initiated in 2023, with engagement of more than 600 people from more than 125 Indigenous organizations. As of the publication of this report, no ombudsperson position has been created. The accountability mechanism the National Inquiry identified as foundational remains unimplemented.
- Call for Justice 1.10 — creation of an independent national Indigenous oversight body — was, as of the 2022 progress report, the subject of "no action." Following a January 2023 round table, Innovation 7 (a First Nations organization based in Pikwakanagan, Ontario) was selected to develop recommendations. As of April 2026, no oversight body exists.

- The Indigenous-led Red Dress Alert program — designed to function as an emergency alert system specifically for missing Indigenous women, girls, and 2SLGBTQQIA+ people — has been the subject of a Manitoba implementation report concluding it must be implemented “without delay.” As of April 2026, full implementation has not occurred.

Part 3: April 2026 — the funding sunset

The CBC report of April 8, 2026

On April 8, 2026 — ten days before the publication of this report — CBC News published an investigation by Joy SpearChief-Morris (the same Indigenous journalist whose January 2026 reporting on NIHB documented in Section 7), titled “MMIWG2S+ programs at risk of losing federal funding, say Indigenous women’s organizations.” The report documents the federal funding sunset affecting key MMIWG2S+ implementation organizations as the 2025-26 fiscal year closed at the end of March 2026.

The specific funding situations documented:

- The National Family and Survivors Circle (NFSC), a non-profit organization working to ensure MMIWG2S+ families are central to efforts to implement the National Inquiry’s 231 Calls to Justice, had core funding of \$840,000 from the previous fiscal year that expired — “sunset” — at the end of March 2026, with no official confirmation of renewal.
- Giganawenimaanaanig, a Manitoba-based MMIWG2S+ implementation organization, presented a report to the federal government in November 2025 and has not received further funding for the project. Crown-Indigenous Relations and Northern Affairs Canada (CIRNAC) confirmed the government is “reviewing the report” “to determine what next steps could look like.”
- Other Indigenous women’s organizations cited at the April 2026 Ottawa news conference — Native Women’s Association of Canada (NWAC), Les Femmes Michif Otipemisiwak, and others — publicly called on the federal government to commit to “long-term sustained, equity funding.”

What the leaders said

Hilda Anderson-Pyrz, President of the National Family and Survivors Circle, led the April 2026 Ottawa news conference. She was joined by:

- Josie Nepinak, President of the Native Women’s Association of Canada (NWAC)
- Lisa Pigeau, Director of Intergovernmental Relations for Les Femmes Michif Otipemisiwak
- Sandra DeLaronde, Executive Director of Giganawenimaanaanig
- Melanie Morrison from Kahnawa:ke, an impacted family member
- NDP MP Leah Gazan

Josie Nepinak's statement: "Allowing funding for MMIWG2S+ programs to sunset undermines progress, disrupts essential services and places lives at risk. It sends a message that this work is temporary, while in reality the need has never been more urgent. Ending this violence requires more than words. It requires action, accountability and leadership."

NDP MP Leah Gazan, speaking previously to the federal funding pattern: "We have pushed this government, but they continue to fail our communities. Meanwhile, gender-based violence is increasing. The supports are just not getting out the door to save lives."

As this report is being written in April 2026, the federal funding for the very organizations the National Inquiry identified as essential to implementing its 231 Calls for Justice is being allowed to sunset. The implementation has not been completed. The funding to complete it is ending. The genocide finding stands. The remedial framework is being defunded."

Part 4: The disability dimension within MMIWG2S+

Why disability compounds vulnerability

The National Inquiry's Final Report documents disability as a specific compounding vulnerability factor in MMIWG2S+ patterns. Indigenous women, girls, and 2SLGBTQQIA+ persons living with disability — cognitive, physical, mental health-related, addiction-related, or developmental — face heightened risk across each of the upstream conditions the Inquiry identified:

- Housing insecurity is more frequent and more acute for disabled Indigenous women, intersecting with the housing failures documented in Section 4 of this report. Disabled women, particularly those whose disabilities affect cognitive or communication function, face documented difficulty navigating shelter systems, eligibility frameworks, and housing application processes.
- Income insecurity, including reliance on disability benefits like AISH and ADAP, places disabled Indigenous women in conditions of dependency that can be exploited by perpetrators. The provincial isolation requirements of AISH — documented in this report's main series, where any household member's income is counted against benefits — produce specific patterns where disabled Indigenous women cannot safely co-house with friends, support networks, or non-romantic partners without losing benefits, increasing isolation and increasing vulnerability.
- Healthcare access, documented in Section 7, is more difficult for disabled Indigenous women. The dual NIHB-AHS framework, the 650,000 Albertans without family physicians, and the documented anti-Indigenous racism in Canadian emergency rooms produce specific risk patterns where disabled Indigenous women are less likely to receive timely medical assessment for injuries that may indicate intimate partner violence.

- Police response patterns to disabled Indigenous women have been documented in the Canadian Journal of Public Health, in Turpel-Lafond's 2020 In Plain Sight BC report, and in MMIWG Inquiry testimony as differentially poor relative to police response to non-disabled non-Indigenous women in the same circumstances. Reports of missing disabled Indigenous women have been documented as receiving delayed and minimized police response — in some cases, response that did not occur until family members repeatedly escalated through media and political channels.

The Amanda Kilabuk framework

Amanda Kilabuk, Director of the MMIWG2S+ Urban Indigenous Action Group, articulated the structural prevention framework in 2024 reporting: "There needs to be substantial investment in Indigenous communities, Indigenous-led organizations to do the work. We know what we need to do in order to provide the programs and services for families and survivors to do prevention. It means housing, it means access to healthcare, it means food security, it means guaranteed livable income. It means employment opportunities, there needs to be access to shelters, there needs to be more investment in all aspects of daily living."

Each item in Kilabuk's list corresponds to a section of this report: housing (Section 4), healthcare (Section 7), food security (intersecting with Section 4 housing and Section 6 water), guaranteed livable income (the entire AISH and ADAP file documented in this report and the Alberta Disability System Breakdown main series), shelters (intersecting with the gender-based violence framework), and "all aspects of daily living" — which is the operational definition of the disability supports the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition is reducing.

Part 5: The Alberta cascade and its MMIWG2S+ implications

Section 10 of this report documented the cascade by which AISH withdrawal under the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition produces the conditions for disabled Indigenous Albertans to enter the corrections system. That same cascade produces the conditions identified by the National Inquiry as upstream causes of MMIWG2S+ vulnerability. The pathway is:

- AISH benefit reduction or revocation produces income loss.
- Income loss produces housing instability — either eviction from current housing or inability to afford the rent that was already exceeding the AISH benefit.
- Housing instability produces homelessness or insecure housing arrangements, including dependency on residence with intimate partners, family members, or others whose conduct may include violence.
- Dependency on housing with potentially violent partners or household members reduces the disabled Indigenous woman's ability to leave violent situations, because leaving requires housing she does not have access to.

- Reduced ability to leave violent situations produces sustained exposure to violence.
- Sustained exposure to violence produces, at population scale, the documented MMIWG2S+ pattern.

The cascade is not hypothetical. Each step is documented in Statistics Canada data on housing insecurity and intimate partner violence, in the National Inquiry testimony, in the AFN's ongoing reporting, and in the provincial administrative apparatus this report has documented across Sections 4, 9, and 10. The provincial government that is implementing the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition is the same provincial government that operates the child welfare system documented in Section 9, the same provincial government that operates the corrections data-match system documented in Section 10, and the same provincial government whose Premier (Section 17 backgrounder) has questioned the legitimacy of unmarked grave reports and other Indigenous truth-telling. The cascade conditions for MMIWG2S+ vulnerability are not being created in some abstract jurisdiction. They are being administratively constructed in Alberta, through specific policy decisions, by named officials, against the documented population this report concerns.

What this section establishes for the remainder of the report

The 2019 National Inquiry into Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Girls concluded, on the basis of testimony from more than 2,380 family members and survivors, that the documented pattern of violence against Indigenous women, girls, and 2SLGBTQQIA+ people constitutes a genocide. The Inquiry produced 231 Calls for Justice. Two have been completed. As this report is published in April 2026, the federal funding for the organizations leading implementation of the Calls is being allowed to sunset. The genocide finding is operative. The remedial mechanism is being defunded.

Indigenous women are twelve times more likely to go missing or be murdered than non-Indigenous women in Canada. Disabled Indigenous women face additional compounded vulnerabilities arising from each of the upstream conditions the National Inquiry identified — housing, income, healthcare, police response, isolation — all of which are administratively shaped in Alberta by the AISH and ADAP framework this report has been documenting throughout. The July 1, 2026 ADAP transition is therefore not merely a disability income policy. It is a measurable contributor to MMIWG2S+ vulnerability among disabled Indigenous women in Alberta, operating through the cascade documented in Part 5 of this section.

Sections 12 through 15 will address consultation failure and UNDRIP Article 21, the Sovereignty Act's relationship to Treaty, TRC Calls to Action 18 through 24, and the July 1, 2026 ADAP transition synthesis. The pattern documented in Section 11 — federal commission of inquiry, formal genocide finding, 231 Calls for Justice, near-zero implementation, federal defunding of the implementation organizations, and provincial administrative cascade producing the upstream conditions the Inquiry identified as causal — is the most morally serious finding in this report. It will shape how the remaining sections are read.

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